US Family Planning Policy

Also, US Population Policies both Domestic and International

Lecture 1.9 – October 3rd, 2024

Roadmap

- US family planning policy
- The US’s influence on global population policies
- Measuring mortality

Does the United States have a Domestic Family Planning Policy?

Does the United States have a Domestic Family Planning Policy?

- Comstock Laws (1870s)

Primarily Related to Contraceptives

"Every obscene, lewd, or lascivious, and every filthy book, pamphlet, picture, paper, letter, writing, print, or other publication of an indecent character, and every article or thing designed, adapted, or intended for preventing conception or producing abortion…is hereby declared to be a non-mailable matter and shall not be conveyed in the mails or delivered from any post office or by any letter carrier."

Does the
Domestic

- Comstock La arily Related to raceptives

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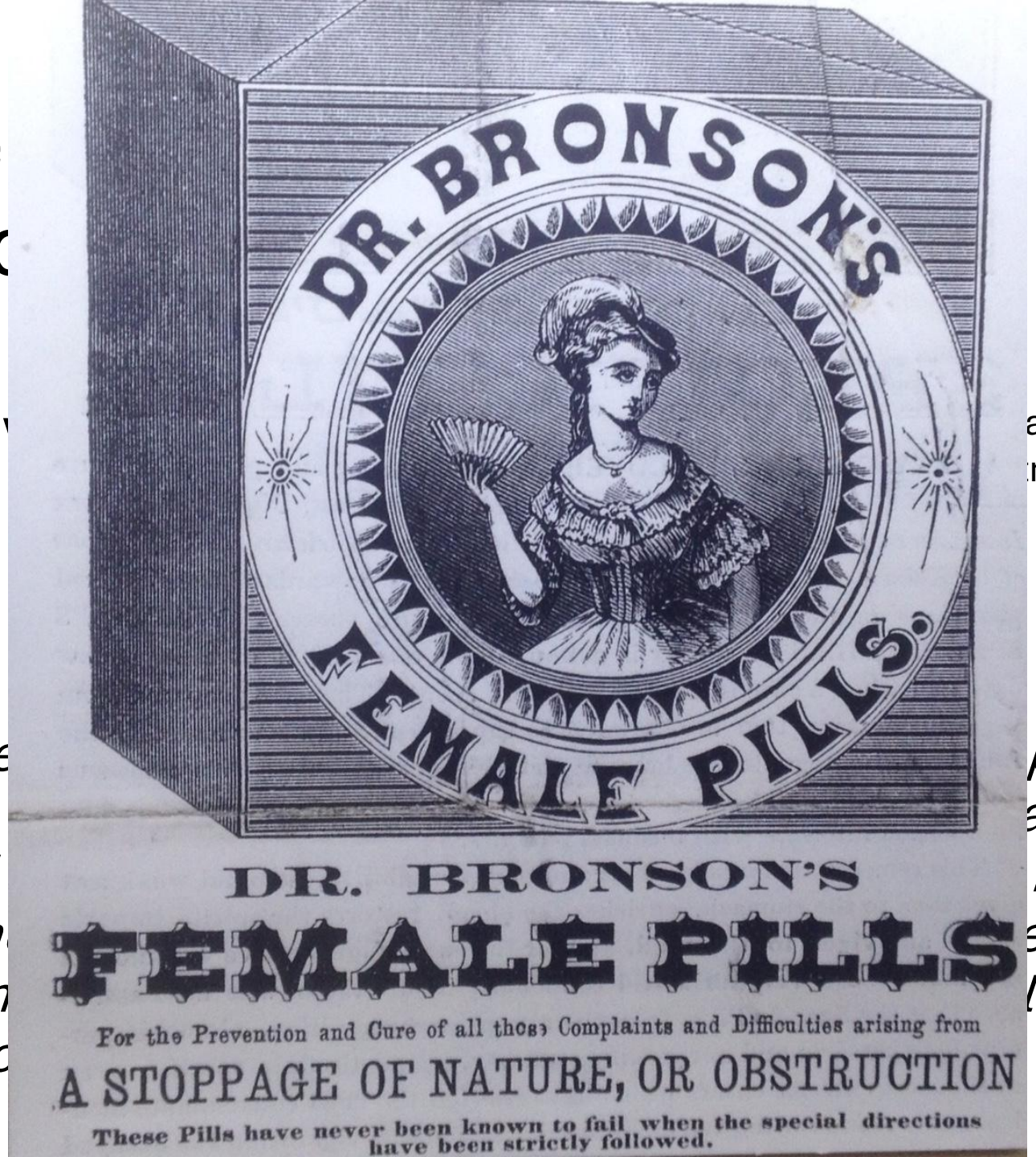

Does the United States have a Domestic Family Planning Policy?

- Comstock Laws (1870s)
- Griswold v. Connecticut (1965) – right to privacy
  - Eisenstadt v. Baird (1972) extended that to unmarried

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Birth Control Law Of State Nullified

U.S. Supreme Court, in 7 to 2 Opinion, Holds Statute Passed in 1879 Is Unconstitutional

By ROBERT D. BYRNES

WASHINGTON — The United States Supreme Court Monday

cally in the Constitution, he said. Much of the Goldberg-Warren-Brennan opinion is an

Does the
Domesti

- Comstock La
- Griswold v. C
  - Eisenstadt v

arily Related to
raceptives

PULL REPORT SEE PAGE 18

LARGEST DAILY CIRCULATION IN NEW ENGLAND

10 Cents — Friday, April 7, 1967 — 80 Pages

COMPLETE

Vice Squad Nabs BU Birth Control Speaker

STORY ON PAGE TWO

TOP OF THE NEWS TODAY

HHH given rough time by hecklers in Berlin. —Page 2

84-MINUTE cross-examination fails to shake nurse, accuser of Speck. —Page 3

NEGOTIATIONS resume in TV, radio strike as union gains support. —Page 4

SOMERVILLE cops on alert, set to quell any further student disorders. —Page 3

BOUNDARIES named for 7 state regions in mental health plan. —Page 2

SCHOOL prayers ruled illegal by N. H. Supreme Court. —Page 3

BITTER PILL — William Baird, left above, is forced to suffer the consequences by being placed under arrest by Vice Squad Officer Edward Hale, after giving a lecture, left, to Boston University students on birth

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Primarily Related to Contraceptives

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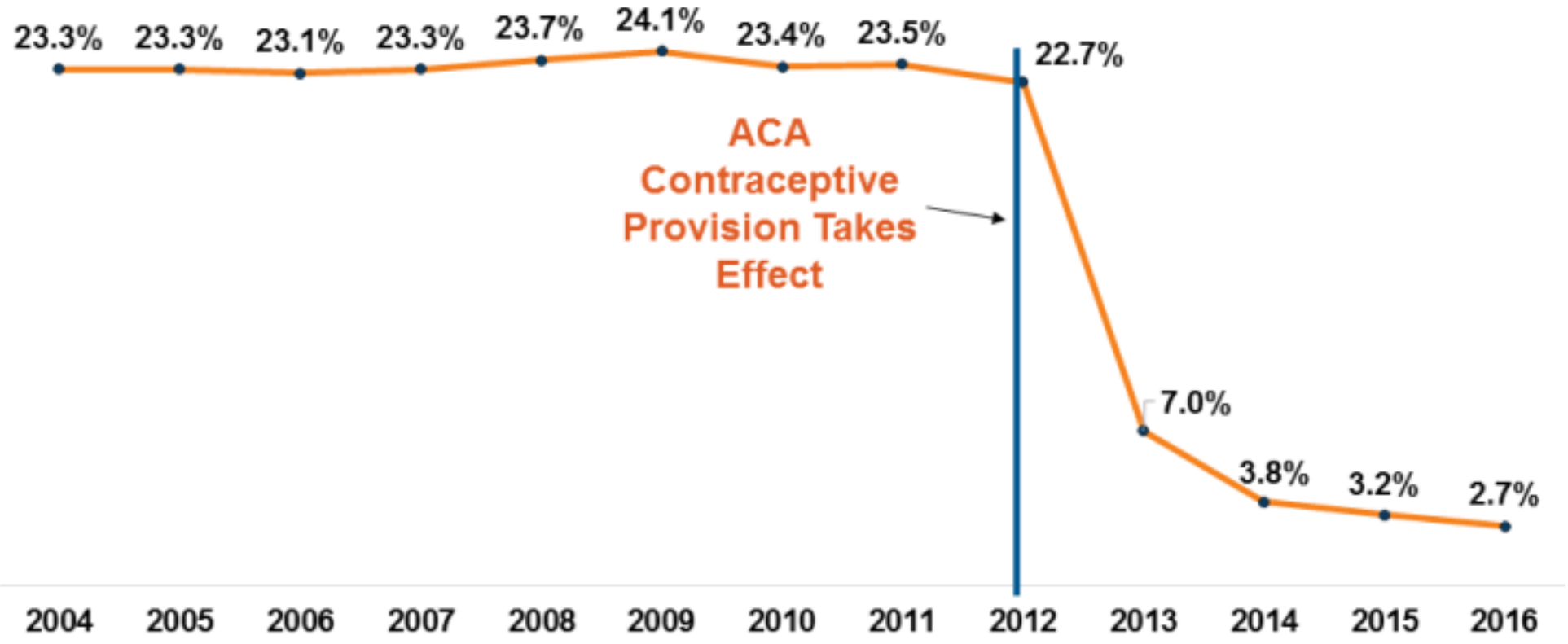
Figure 2

The Contraceptive Coverage Policy Has Had a Large Impact on Out-Of-Pocket Spending in a Short Amount of Time

Share of insured women reporting any out-of-pocket spending on oral contraceptives



NOTE: Share of Women age 15-44 with health coverage from a large employer who have any out-of-pocket spending on oral contraceptive pills, 2004-2015.
SOURCE: Kaiser Family Foundation analysis of Truven Health Analytics MarketScan Commercial Claims and Encounters Database, 2004 – 2016. Peterson-Kaiser Health System Tracker.

KFF
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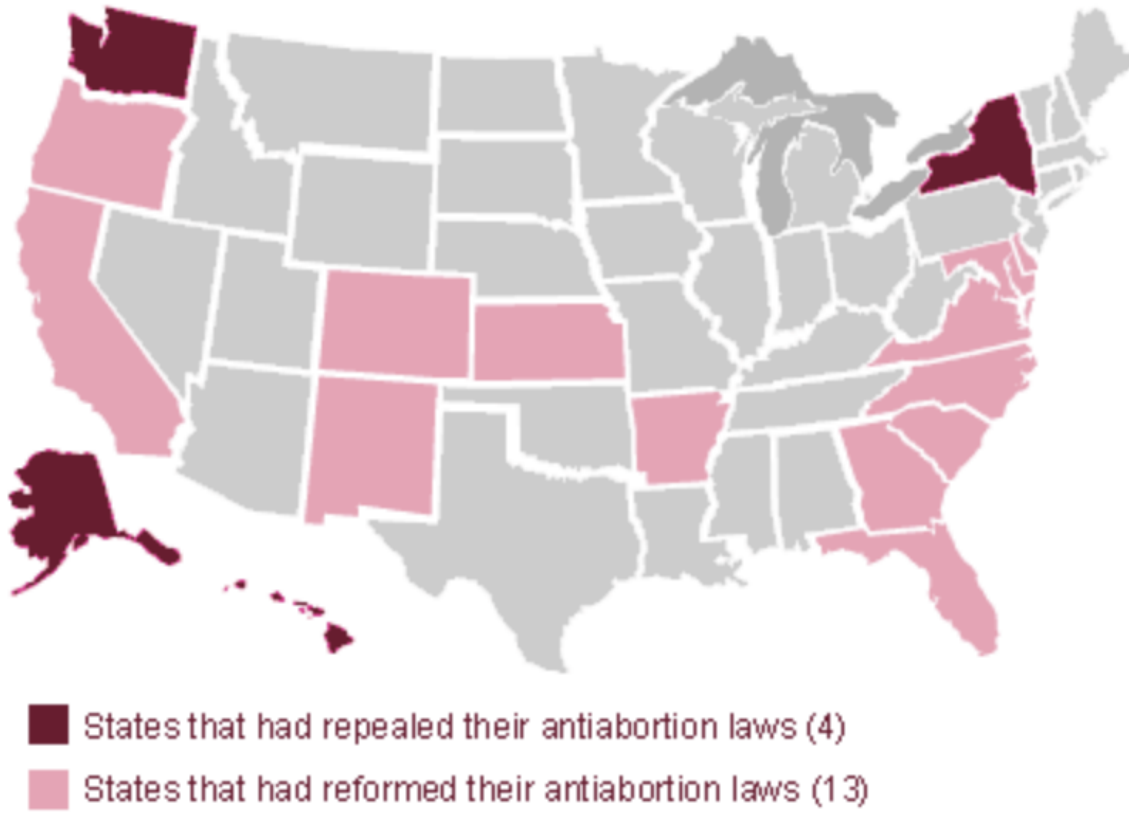
Primarily Related to Contraceptives

- State Abortion Policy before 1973

Abortion Policy

State Abortion Laws Before *Roe*



Note: Status of state laws in 1972. *Source:* Rachel Benson Gold, *Abortion and Women's Health: A Turning Point for America?,* The Alan Guttmacher Institute, New York, 1990.

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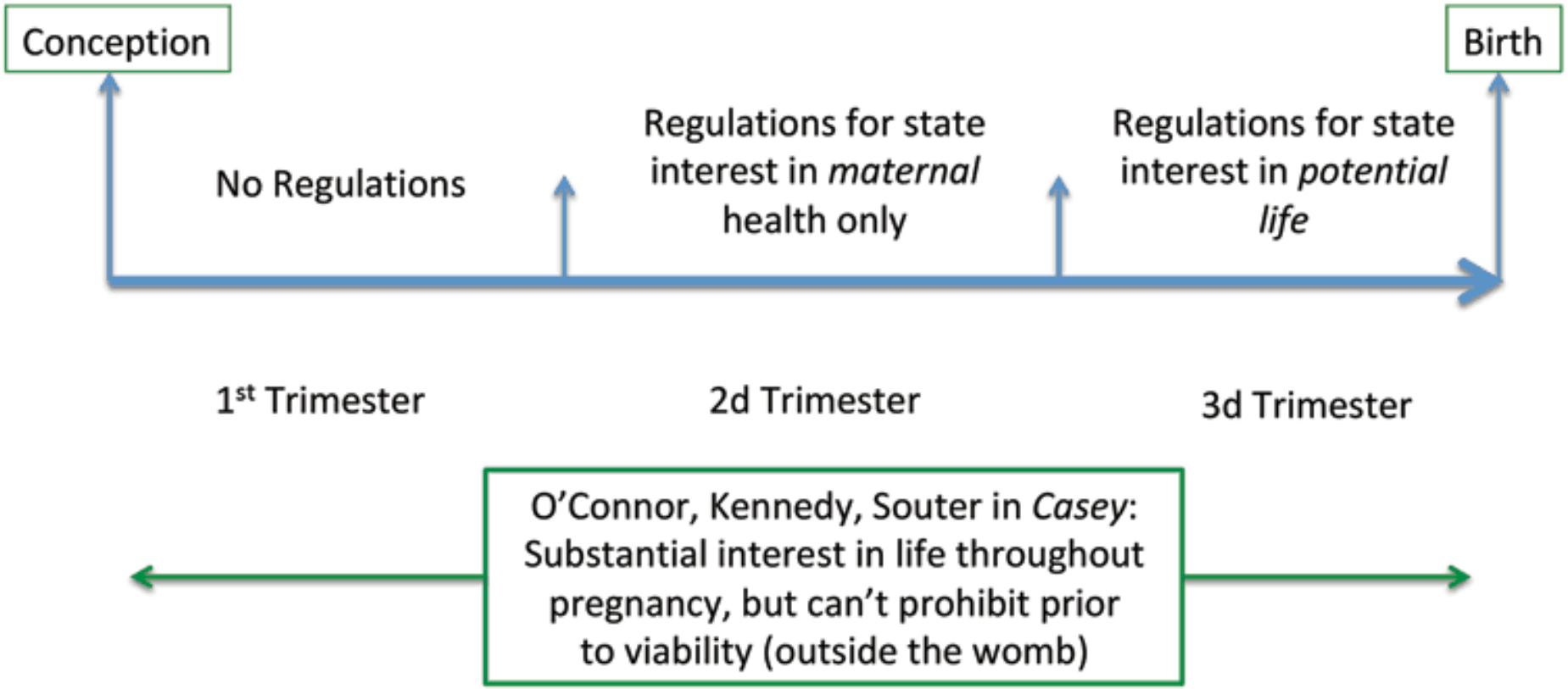
- Roe v. Wade Supreme Court Ruling (1973)
  - Planned Parenthood v. Casey (1992): “undue burden”

Abortion Policy

Roe's Trimester Framework Balancing a **Woman's** Interest in Abortion and **State's** Interest in Maternal Health and Potential Life



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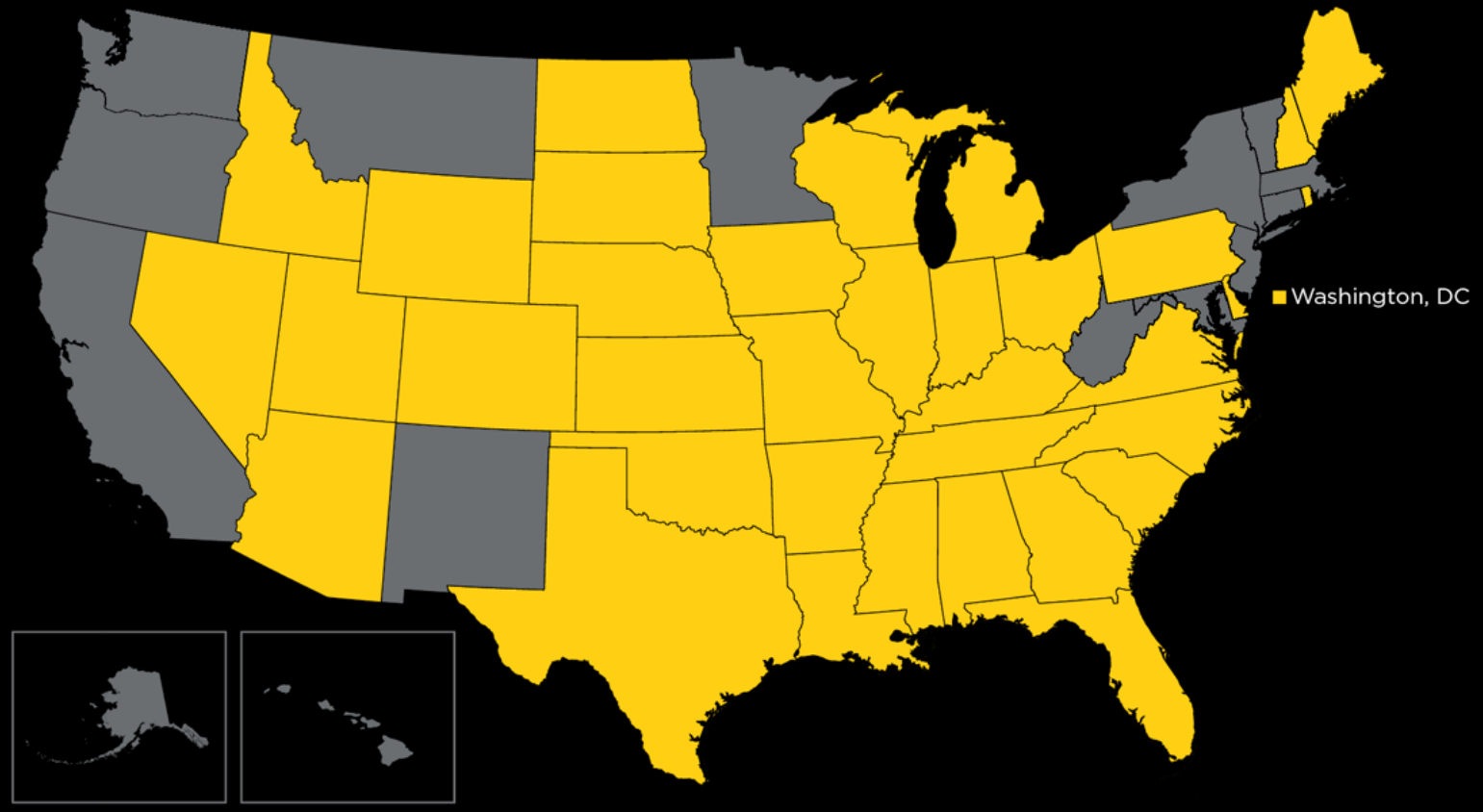
- Hyde Amendment (1980, 1997): Medicaid does not pay for abortions

Abortion Policy

GUTTMACHER INSTITUTE

In 35 states and DC, women enrolled in Medicaid have coverage for abortion only in the most extreme circumstances.



gu.tt/Hyde2016

©2016

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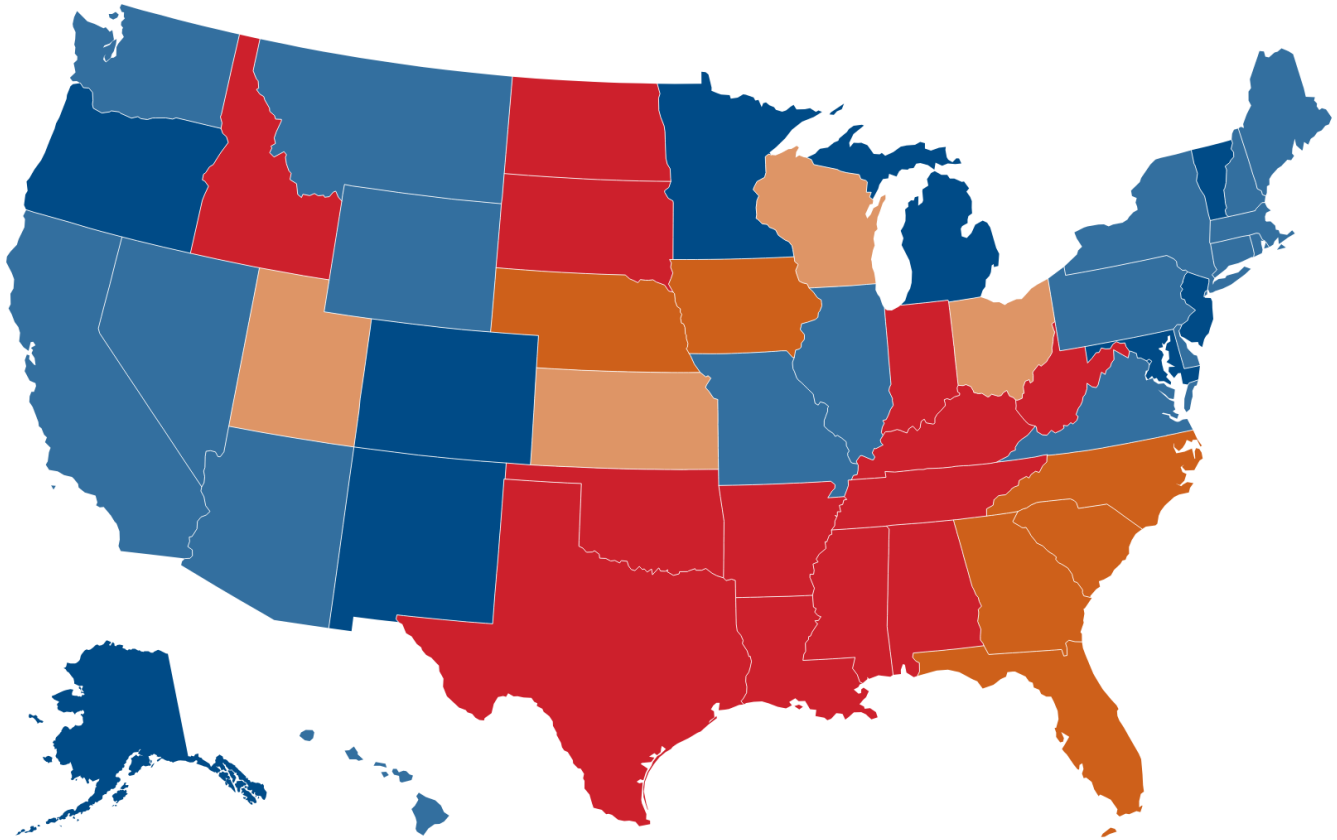
- Hyde Amendment (1980, 1997): Medicaid does not pay for abortions
- Dobbs v. Jackson Women's Health Organization (2022):
  - States can limit abortion access before viability
  - Future of the right to privacy (contraception)?

Abortion Policy

Status of Abortion Bans in the United States as of January 6, 2026

Hover over state for more details

- Abortion Banned (13 states)
- Gestational limit between 6 and 12 weeks LMP (6 states)
- Gestational limit between 18 and 22 weeks LMP (4 states)
- Gestational limit at or near viability (18 states)
- No gestational limits (9 states & DC)



Note: LMP refers to Last Menstrual Period. *Viability* is the point when a fetus can survive outside the womb and is generally presumed to occur at around 24 weeks gestation. However, viability it has never been properly defined by courts and depends on the individual pregnancy and on various factors, including gestational age, fetal weight and sex, and medical interventions available. For more details please see our trackers on **exceptions to state abortion bans and early gestational limits, abortion-related ballot initiatives, state and federal litigation,** and our KFF State Health Facts page on **abortion policies.**

Source: KFF analysis of state policies and court decisions, as of January 6, 2026.

AUGUST 2022

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
	1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12	13
14	15	16 SEX	17 OVULATION	18	19	20
21	22	23	24	25	26 IMPLANTATION	27
28	29	30	31			

Download & Print Free Calendars From **Wiki Calendar**

SEPTEMBER 2022

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
				1	2	3
4	5 Labor Day	6	7	8	9	10
11 Patriot Day	12	13	14	15	16	17
18	19	20	21 DOCTOR	22 Autumn Begins	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30	

Download & Print Free Calendars From **Wiki-Calendar.Com**

AUGUST 2022

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
	1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8 LMP began	9	10	11	12	13
14	15	16 SEX	17 OVULATION	18	19	20
21	22	23	24	25	26 IMPLANTATION	27
28	29	30	31			

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SEPTEMBER 2022

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
				1	2	3
4	5 Labor Day	6	7	8	9	10
11 Patriot Day	12 Know period is late	13	14	15	16	17
18	19	20 DOCTOR	21	22 Autumn Begins	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30	

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Takeaway: 6 weeks is not a lot!

Iowa, Nebraska, Georgia, South Carolina, Florida have 6-weeks bans

US Abortion Policy Affects US Foreign Assistance and Population Policy

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  - No funding for countries to support abortion

US Abortion Policy Affects US Foreign Assistance and Population Policy

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  - No funding for countries to support abortion
  - "**No foreign assistance funds** may be used to **pay for the performance of abortion** as a method of family planning or to motivate or coerce any person to practice abortions."
  - Lawmaker backlash to Roe v. Wade Supreme Court Decision

US Abortion Policy Affects US Foreign Assistance and Population Policy

- Helm's Amendment to the Foreign Assistance Act (1973)
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US Abortion Policy Affects US Foreign Assistance and Population Policy

- Helm's Amendment to the Foreign Assistance Act (1973)
  - No funding for countries to support abortion
- Mexico City Policy, *"Global Gag Rule"* (1984 and beyond)
  - No funding for countries **who** support abortion
  - Nongovernmental organizations **receiving US family planning assistance cannot use separately obtained non-U.S. funds** to inform the public or advocate to their government on making safe **abortion** available, providing legal abortion services, or provide advice on where to get an abortion

Mexico City Policy, *"Global Gag Rule"* Administrative Application

- Bill Clinton, 1993: Rescinded it
- George W. Bush, 2001: Reinstated it
- Barack Obama, 2009: Repealed it
  - Also, reinstated $50 million in annual funding for UNFPA
- President Trump, 2017: Reinstated it.
  - **Extended restrictions** on abortion *counseling* to the broader group of **organizations supported by U.S. global health funds –** previous policy was limited to family planning NGOs
- President Biden, 2020: Rescinded it
- President Trump, 2024: … what do you think?

What is Life Expectancy? And What does it tell us about Population Health?

Life Expectancy, Period vs. Cohorts, and Morbidity

Lecture 2.1 – October 8th , 2024

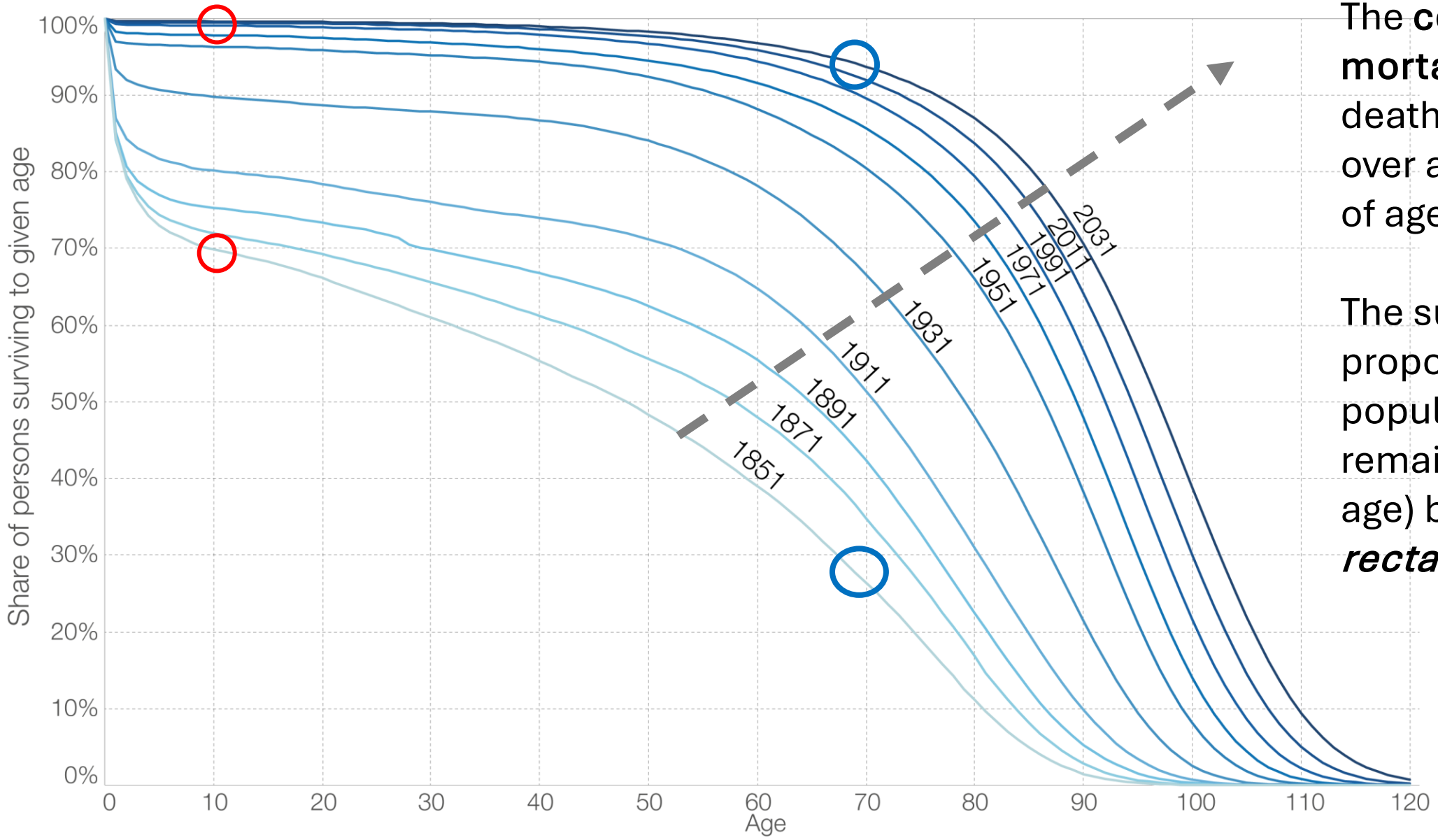
Life Span vs. Life Expectancy

- **Life span** = length of an individual life

- **Life expectancy** = average length of life in a population
  - (average of entire population's lifespans)
  - e_0 = life expectancy at age 0 (birth)
  - e_{25} = life expectancy at age 25
  - …

Share of persons surviving to successive ages for persons born 1851 to 2031, England and Wales

according to mortality rates experienced or projected, (on a cohort basis)



The **compression of mortality** means that death is concentrated over a smaller range of ages

The survival curve (the proportion of the population that remains alive at each age) begins to look ***rectangular***

Data source: Office for National Statistics (ONS). Note: Life expectancy figures are not available for the UK before 1951; for long historic trends England and Wales data are used

The interactive data visualization is available at OurWorldinData.org. There you find the raw data and more visualizations on this topic.

Licensed under CC-BY-SA by the author Max Roser.

What is life expectancy?

- **Average** length of life in a **population at a given time**
- Also: the average age at death at a given time

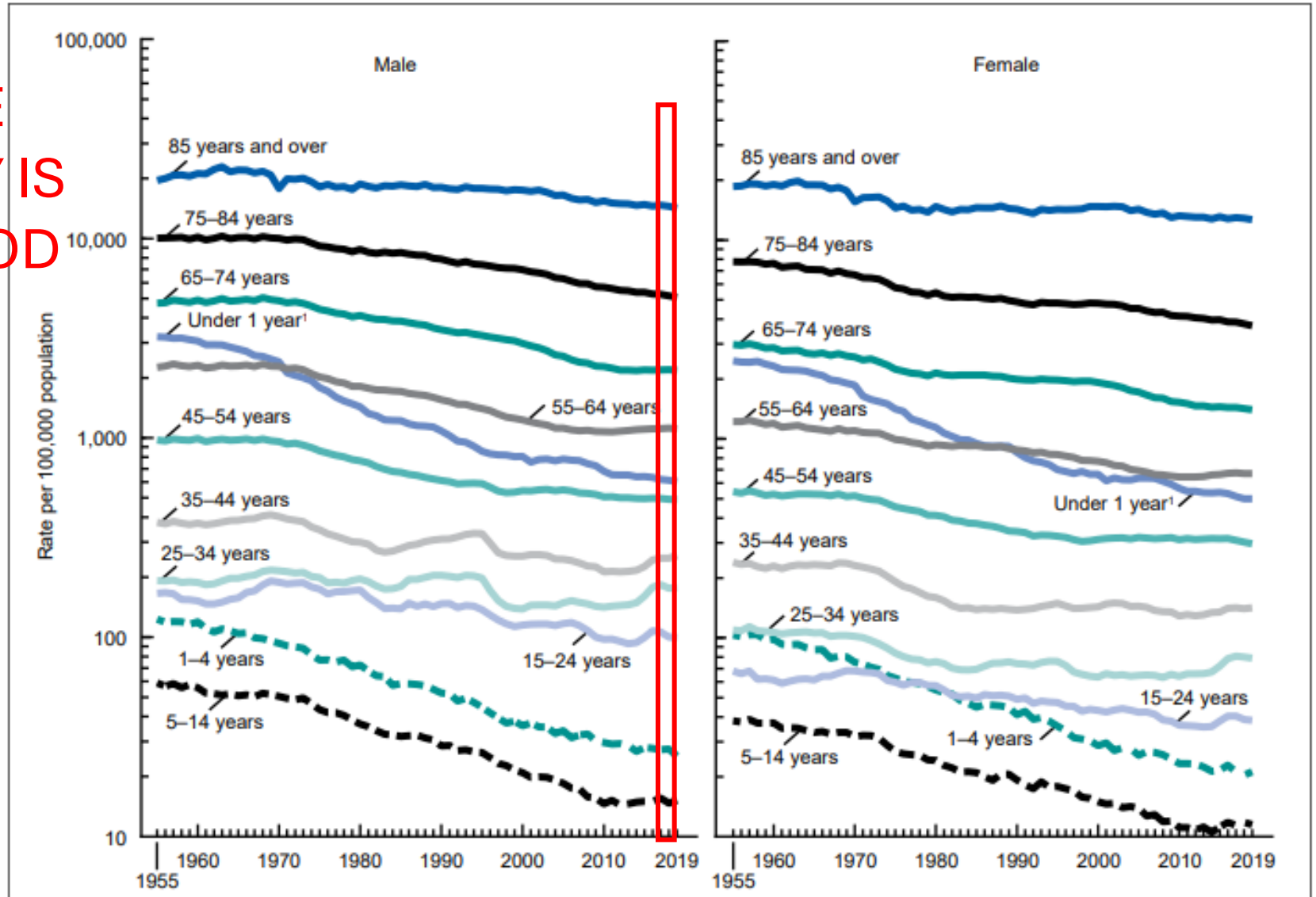
Calculating <u>Period</u> Life Expectancy (e_0)

- The average number of years a baby born today would live if today's birth cohort experienced **today's age-specific and sex-specific mortality rates** as they move through life

- Like the total fertility rate, this is a **period rate** estimated for a ***synthetic cohort***

Like TFR, LIFE EXPECTANCY IS ALSO A PERIOD MEASURE!

Figure 2. Death rates, by age and sex: United States, 1955–2019

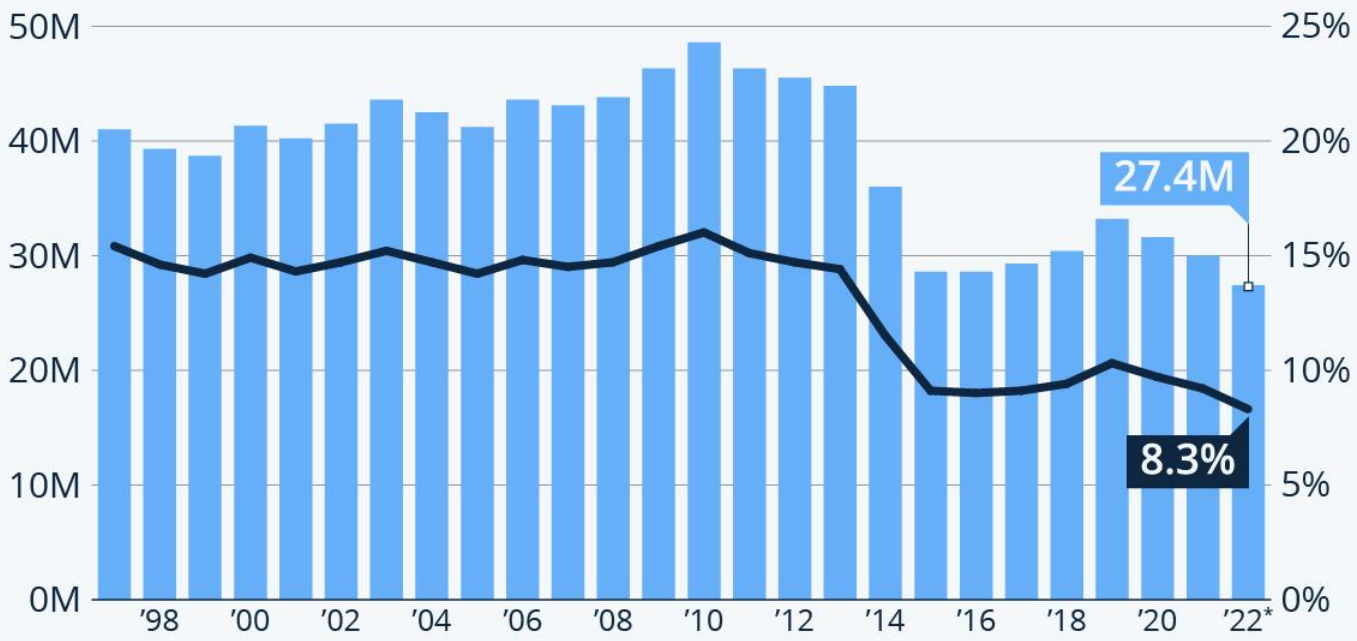


[1]Rates are based on population estimates which differ from infant mortality rates (based on live births); see Figure 5 in this report for infant mortality rates and Technical Notes in this report for more discussion of the difference.
SOURCE: National Center for Health Statistics, National Vital Statistics System, Mortality.

Age in 2019	Cohort (Years Born)	Health-affecting Life Events?
0-4	2015-2019	Healthcare in 2010s
5-14	2005-2014	All the above + Great Recession, Medicaid expansion, Affordable Care Act

Number of U.S. Uninsured Falls Once More

Number and percentage of persons without health insurance coverage in the United States



* first estimate for Jan-Jun
Questionnaire adjusted in 2004
Sources: DHHS, CDC, NCHS

statista

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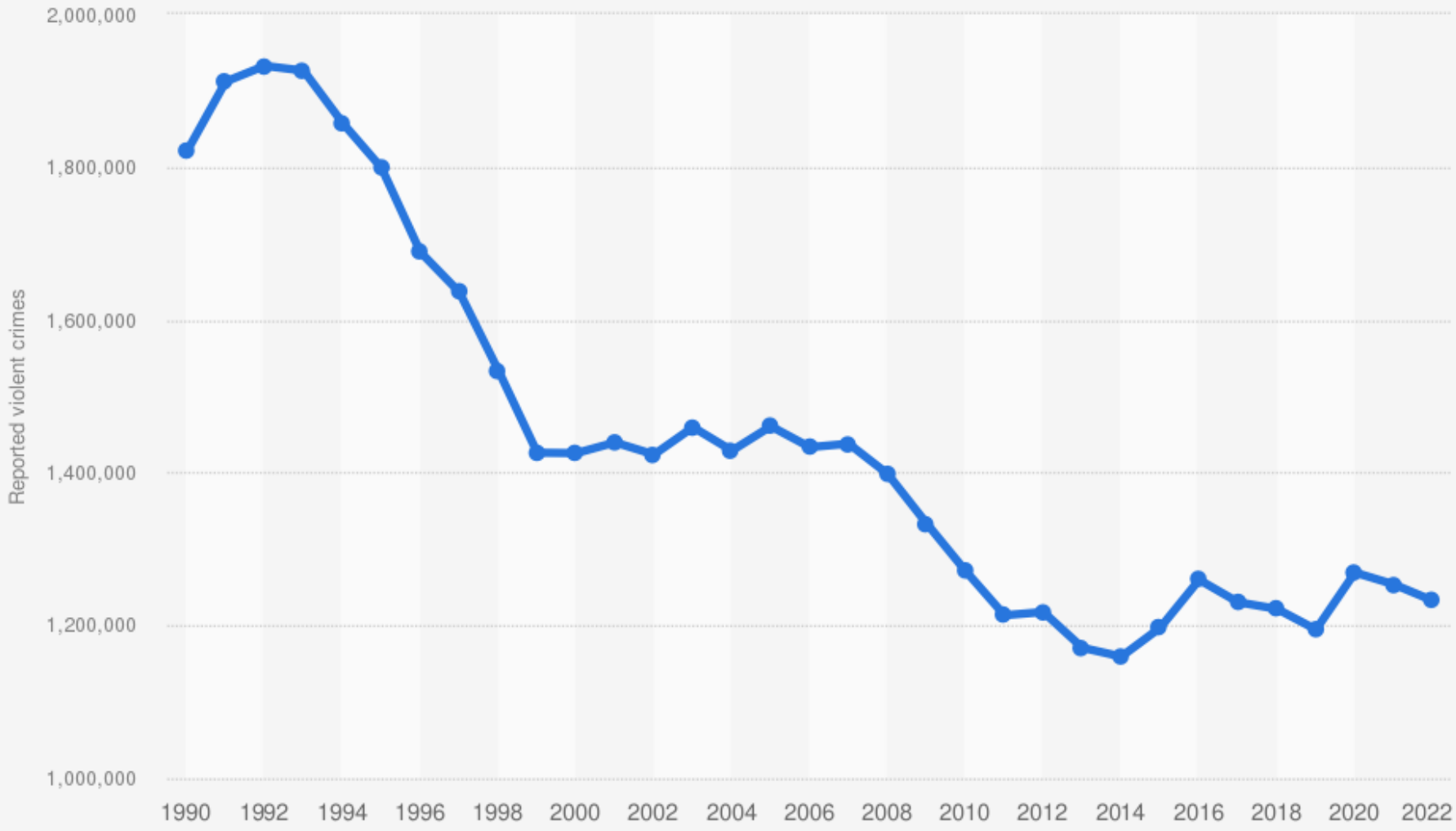
15-24	1995-2004	All the above + Decline in violent crime

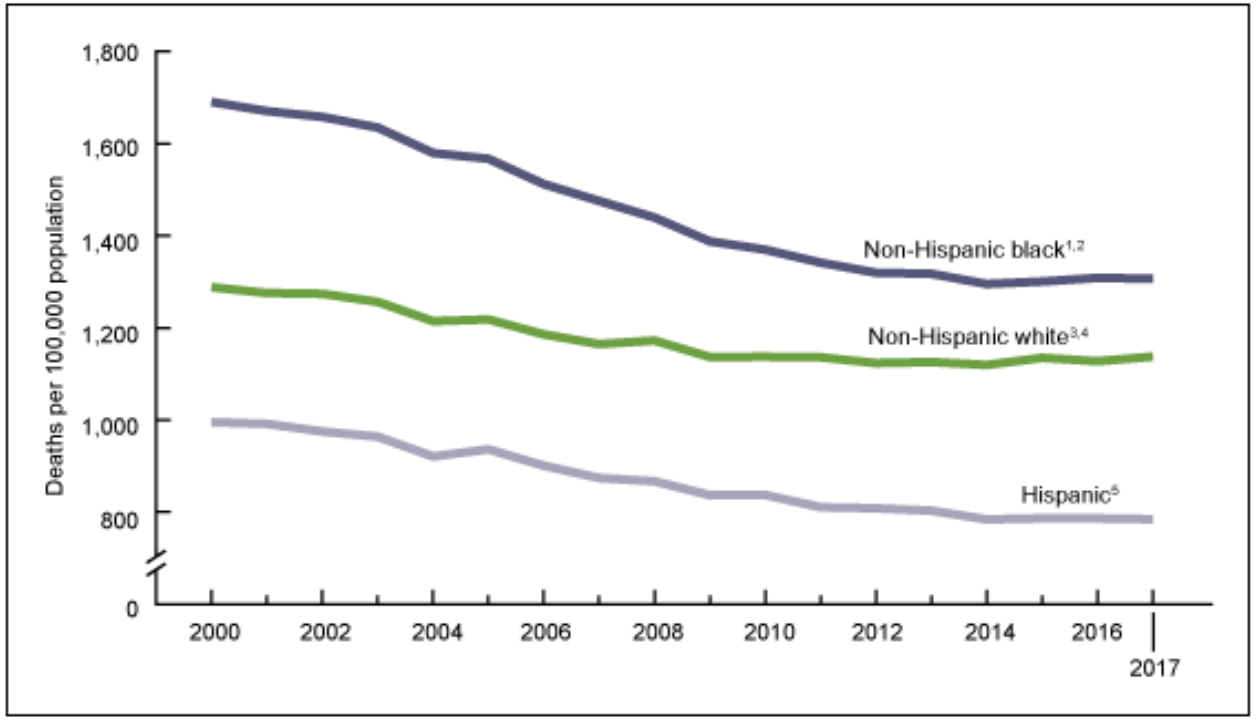
Total violent crime reported in the United States from 1990 to 2022



Source
FBI
© Statista 2024

Additional Information:
United States; 1990 to 2022

Figure 1. Age-adjusted death rates for persons aged 25 and over, by Hispanic origin and race: United States, 2000–2017



[1]Significant decreasing trend for 2000–2012 with different rates of change over time; stable trend for 2012–2017; $p < 0.05$.

[2]Rate significantly higher than the rate for non-Hispanic white and Hispanic persons, $p < 0.05$.

[3]Significant decreasing trend for 2000–2011; stable trend for 2011–2017, $p < 0.05$.

[4]Rate significantly higher than the rate for Hispanic persons, $p < 0.05$.

[5]Significant decreasing trend for 2000–2017 with different rates of change over time; $p < 0.05$.

NOTE: Access data table for Figure 1 .

SOURCE: NCHS, National Vital Statistics System, Mortality.

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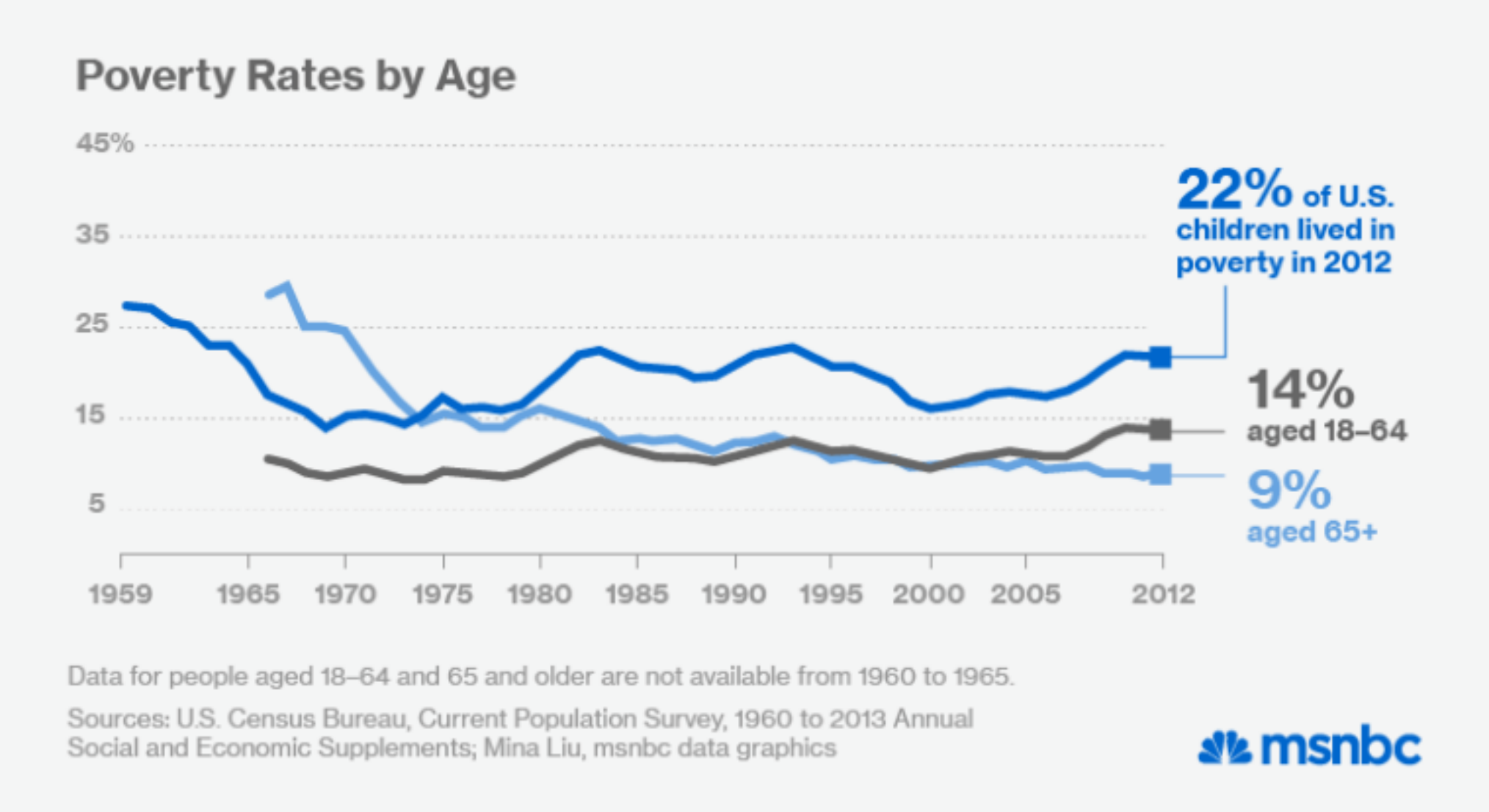
25-34	1985-1994	All the above + Improving economy in 1990's
35-54	1965-1984	All the above + lots of pollution in 1970's, "War on Poverty" in 1960's


Poverty Rates by Age
45%
35
25
15
5
1959
1965
1970
1975
1980
1985
1990
1995
2000
2005
2012
22% of U.S. children lived in poverty in 2012
14% aged 18–64
9% aged 65+
Data for people aged 18–64 and 65 and older are not available from 1960 to 1965.
Sources: U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey, 1960 to 2013 Annual Social and Economic Supplements; Mina Liu, msnbc data graphics
msnbc

Age in 2019	Cohort (Years Born)	Health-affecting Life Events?
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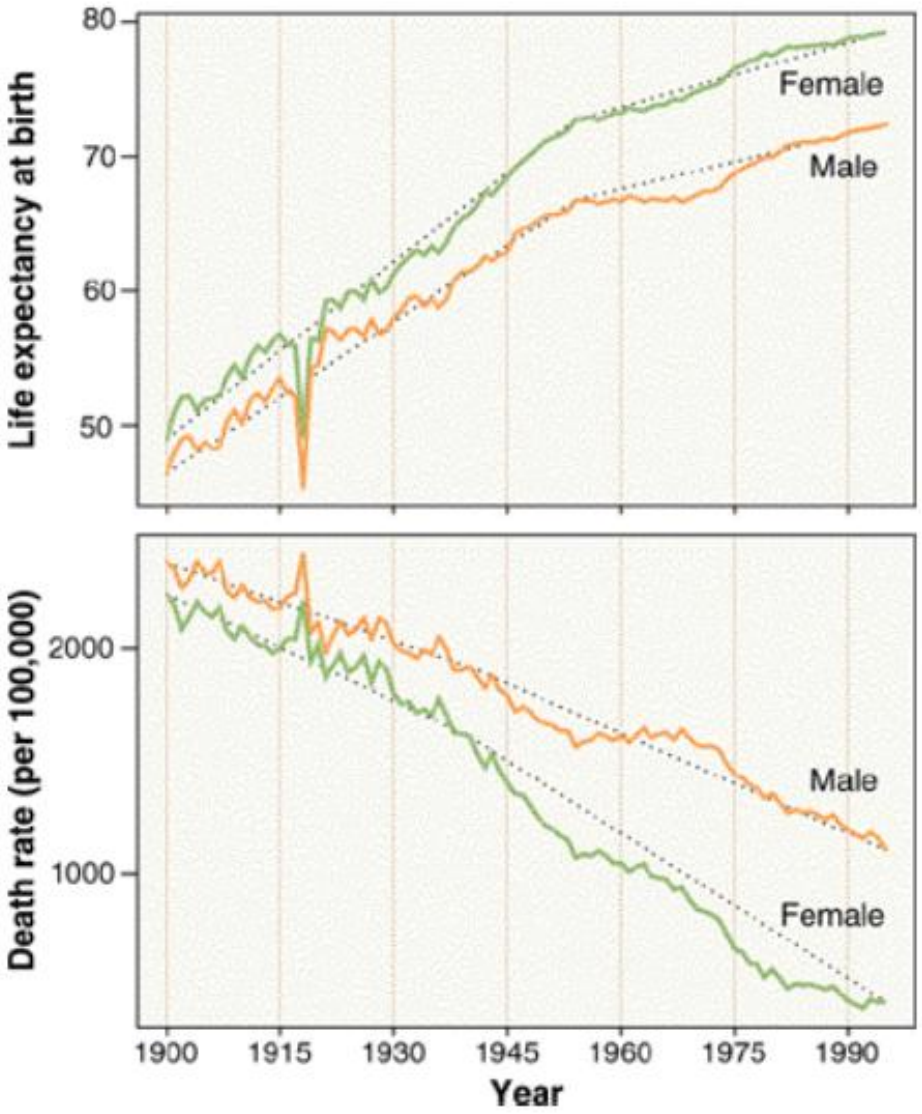
35-54	1965-1984	All the above + lots of pollution in 1970's, "War on Poverty" in 1960's
55-74	1945-1964	All of the above + Baby Boom, suburbanization, Medicaid (1965) covers poor families, Vietnam War
75+	??-1944	All the above + Wars, Great Depression

Can calculate E_0

(life expectancy at birth)

or E_5, E_{65}…



Before 1950: Mortality decline driven by declining infant and child mortality

After 1950: Mortality decline driven by declines at older ages

Life expectancy slowed in the United States around the middle of the 20th century, whereas the decline in death rates has accelerated.

Source: Wilmoth, *Science*, 1995

Death at very young ages pulls down e_0

- Imagine taking an average – you observe age at death for 9 people:
  - 65, 66, 69, 70, 74, 78, 83, 88, 89 Average = 76 years

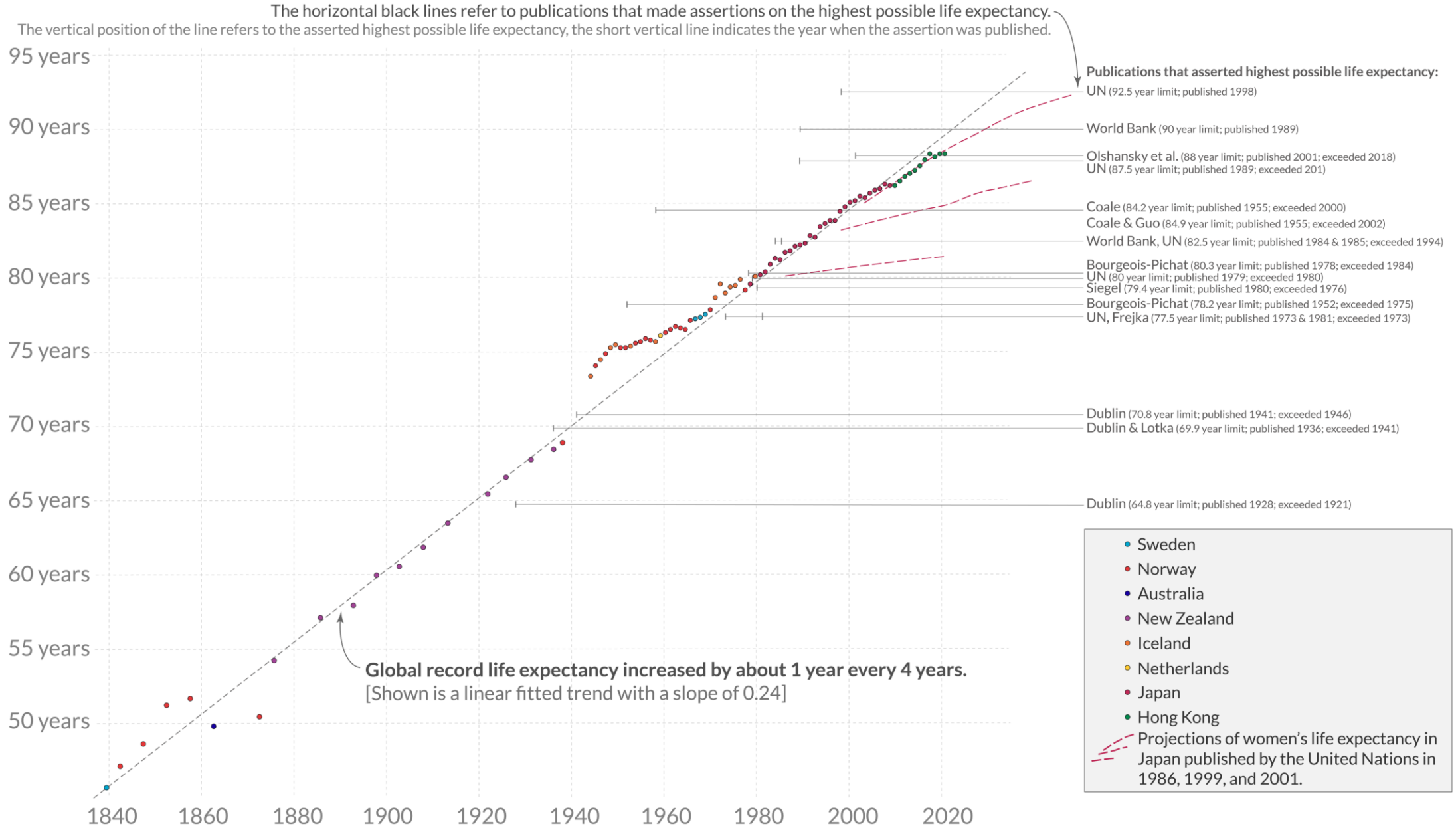
- Now imagine you observe age at death for 10 people:
  - 1, 65, 66, 69, 70, 74, 78, 83, 88, 89 Average = 68.3 years

Improvements in infant mortality have large impacts on e_0!

Record life expectancy over the last two centuries

Shown is the highest known life expectancy of women at each point in time and the country that achieved this

Our World in Data



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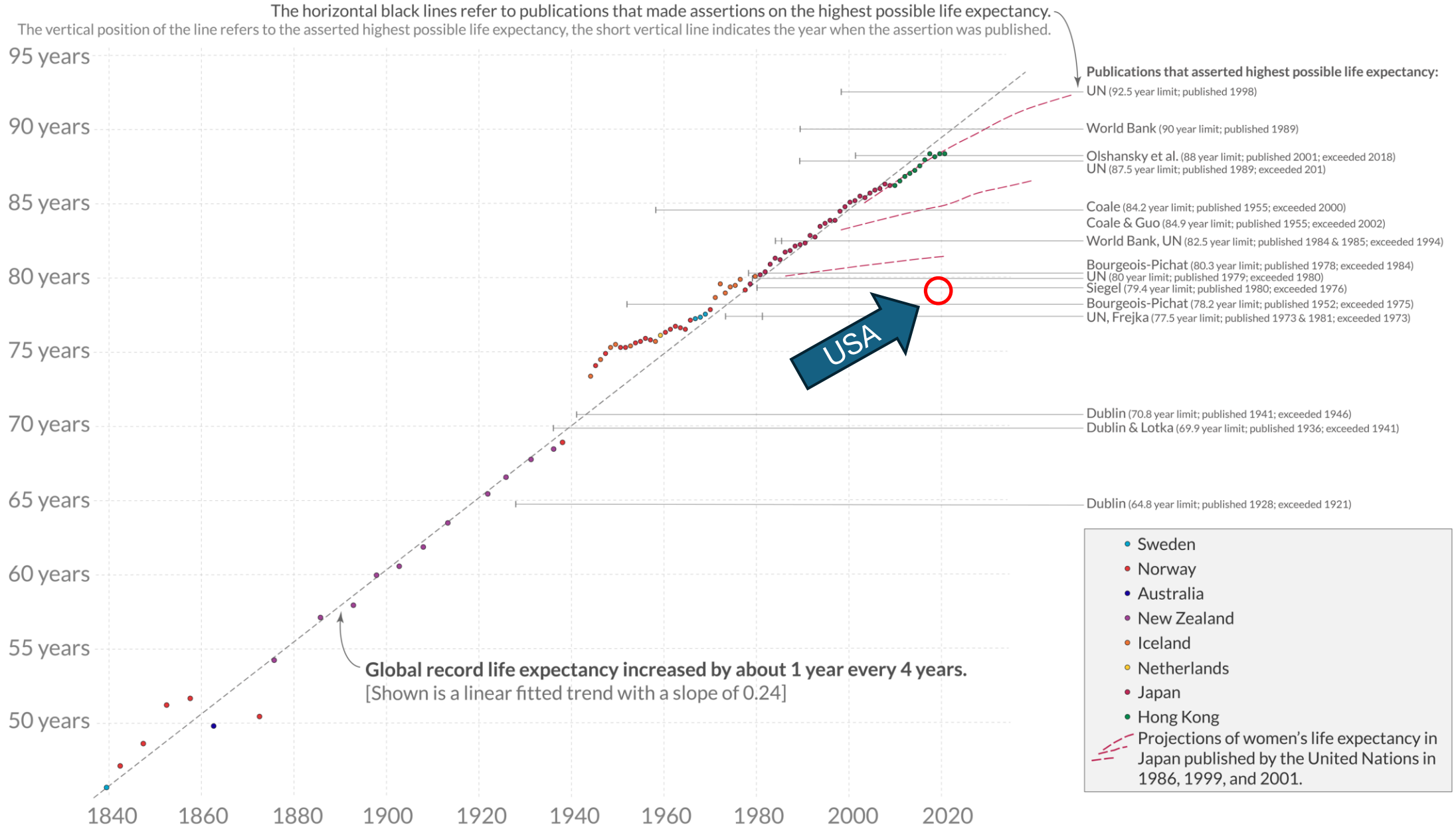
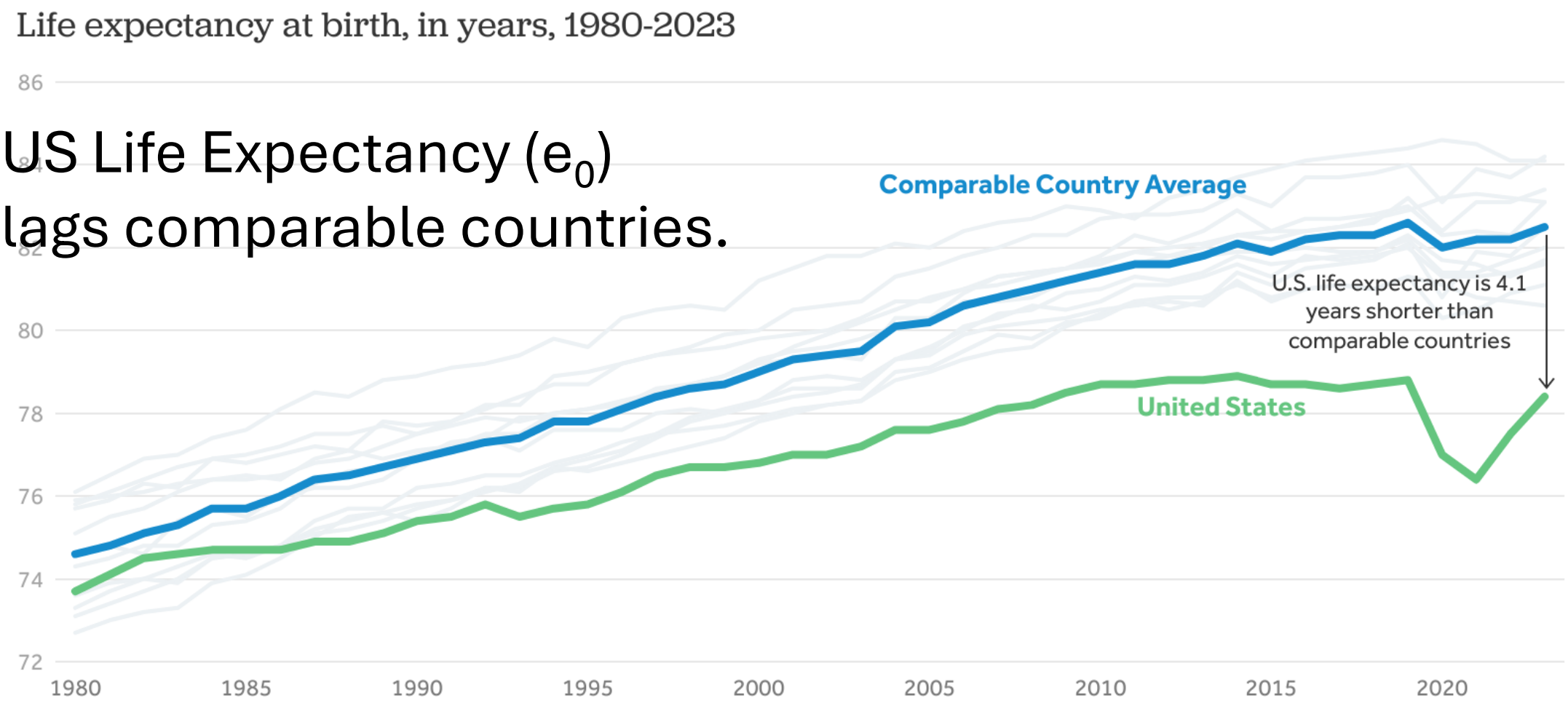


So what’s happening with US Life Expectancy?

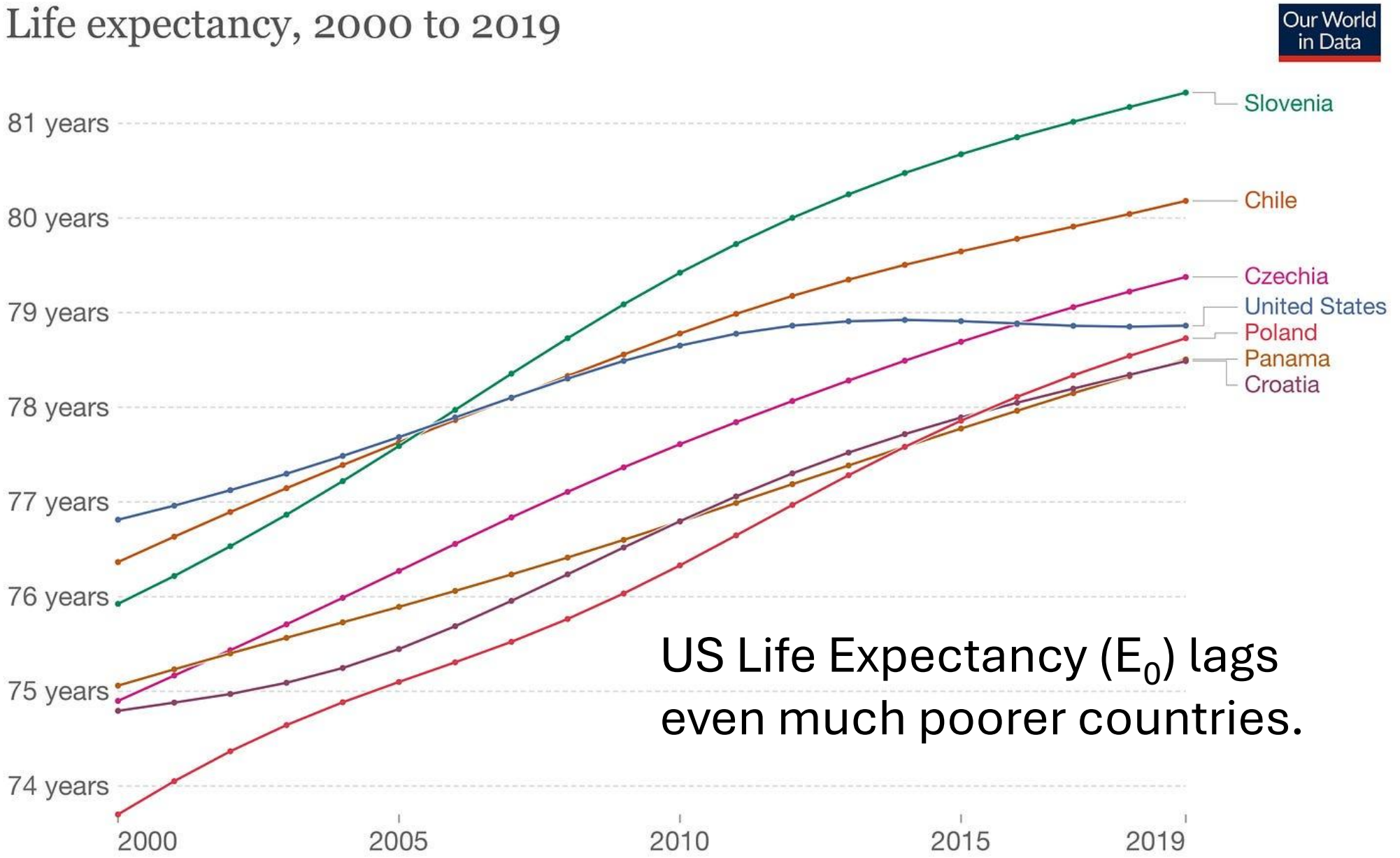
US Life Expectancy (e_0) lags comparable countries.



Notes: Comparable countries include Australia, Austria, Belgium, Canada, France, Germany, Japan, the Netherlands, Sweden, Switzerland, and the U.K. 2023 U.K. life expectancy data is only for England and Wales. See Methods section of "How does U.S. life expectancy compare to other countries?"

Source: KFF analysis of CDC, OECD, Australian Bureau of Statistics, German Federal Statistical Office, Japanese Ministry of Health, Labour, and Welfare, Statistics Canada, and U.K. Office for National Statistics data

Peterson-KFF
Health System Tracker



US Life Expectancy (E_0) lags even much poorer countries.

Source: Riley (2005), Clio Infra (2015), and UN Population Division (2019) OurWorldInData.org/life-expectancy • CC BY
Note: Shown is period life expectancy at birth, the average number of years a newborn would live if the pattern of mortality in the given year were to stay the same throughout its life.

Problems with Life Expectancy: Period vs. Cohort measures again!

- Like period measures of fertility (TFR), Life Expectancy can only take a cross-sectional snapshot
- Does not actually tell you how long you might expect to live!
- Also fluctuates a lot! (like TFR – remember covid!)

Cohort Life expectancy

- **Cohort life expectancy:**
  - Average length of life (age at death) in a *birth cohort*

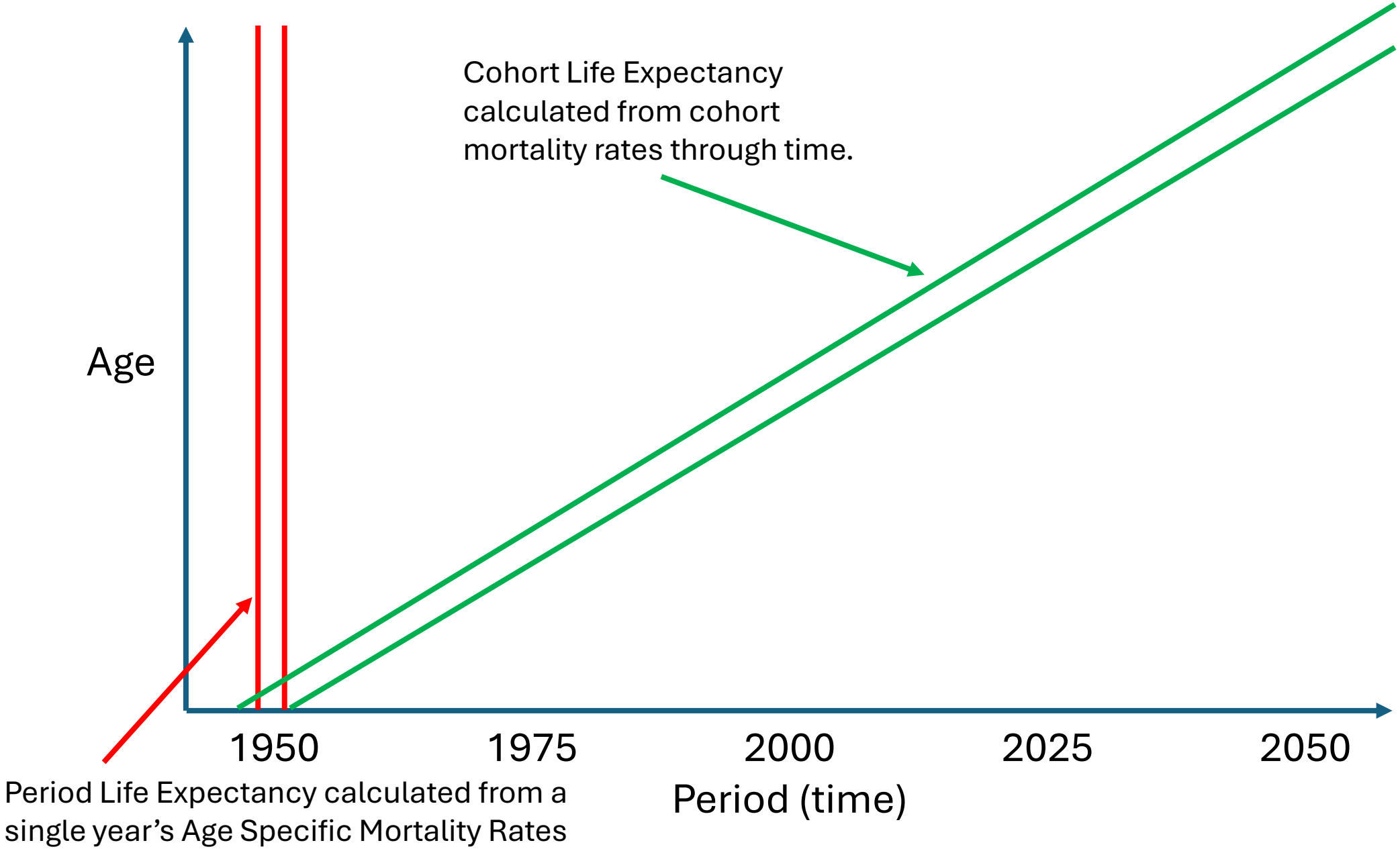
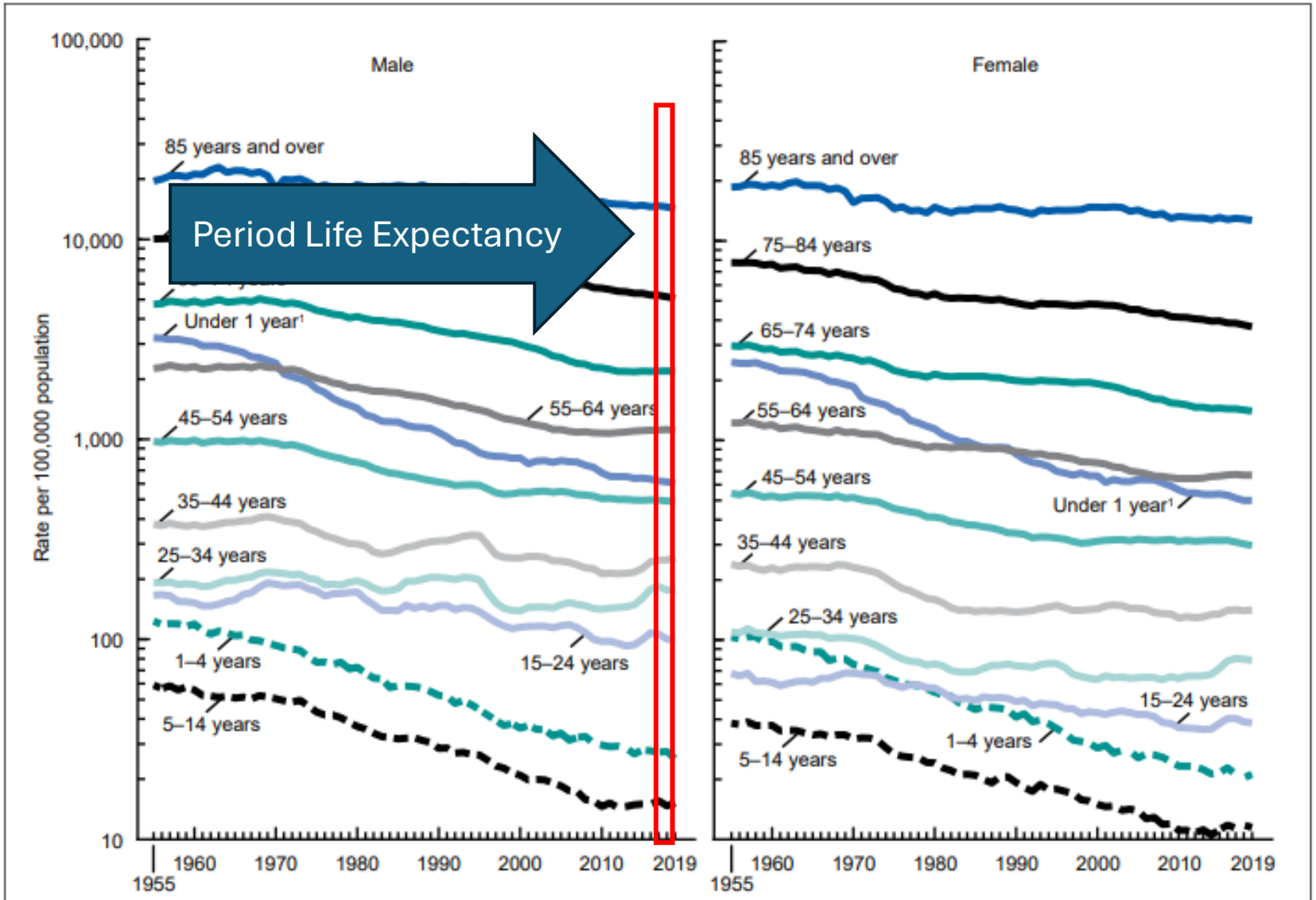

Cohort Life Expectancy calculated from cohort mortality rates through time.
Age
1950
1975
2000
2025
2050
Period (time)
Period Life Expectancy calculated from a single year's Age Specific Mortality Rates

Figure 2. Death rates, by age and sex: United States, 1955–2019



¹Rates are based on population estimates which differ from infant mortality rates (based on live births); see Figure 5 in this report for infant mortality rates and Technical Notes in this report for more discussion of the difference.
SOURCE: National Center for Health Statistics, National Vital Statistics System, Mortality.

Cohort Life Expectancy

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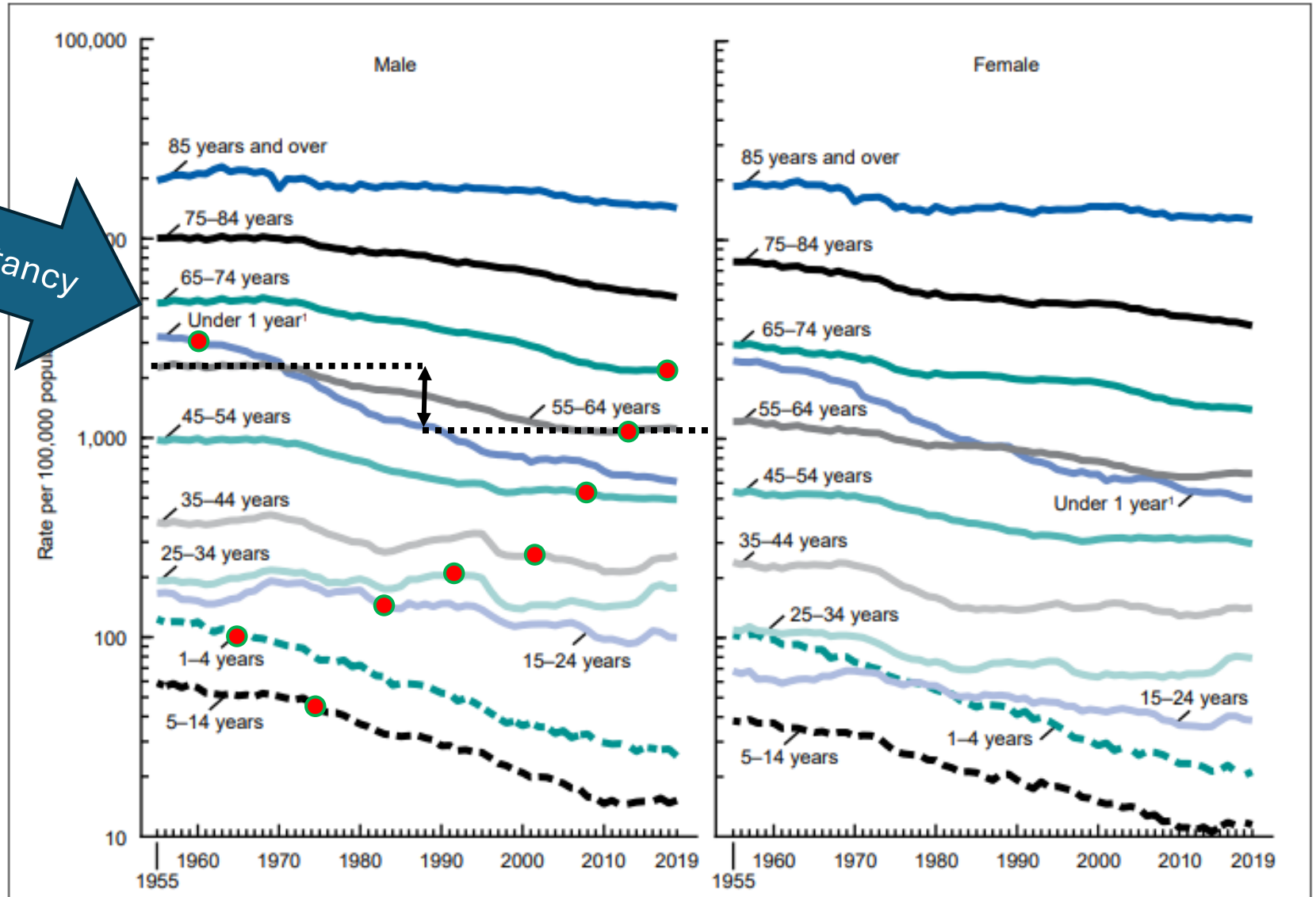

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SOURCE: National Center for Health Statistics, National Vital Statistics System, Mortality.

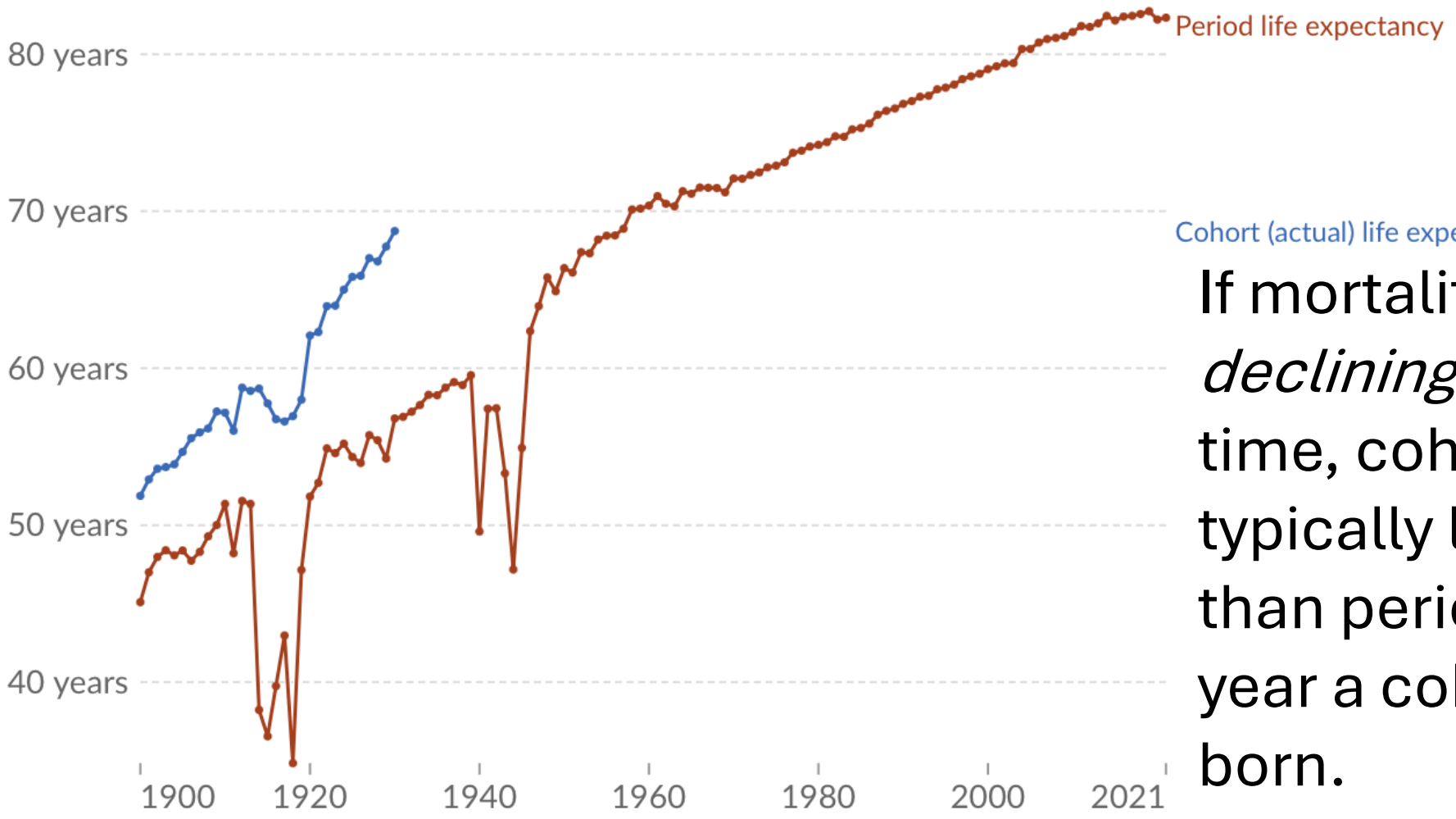
Period versus cohort life expectancy, France

The number of years a person is expected to live, among those born in a given year. This is shown as a comparison between a period measure and a cohort measure.

Our World in Data

Change country or region

All together



If mortality is *declining* over time, cohort e_0 is typically larger than period e_0 the year a cohort was born.

Source: Human Mortality Database (2023)

CC BY

Question of the day

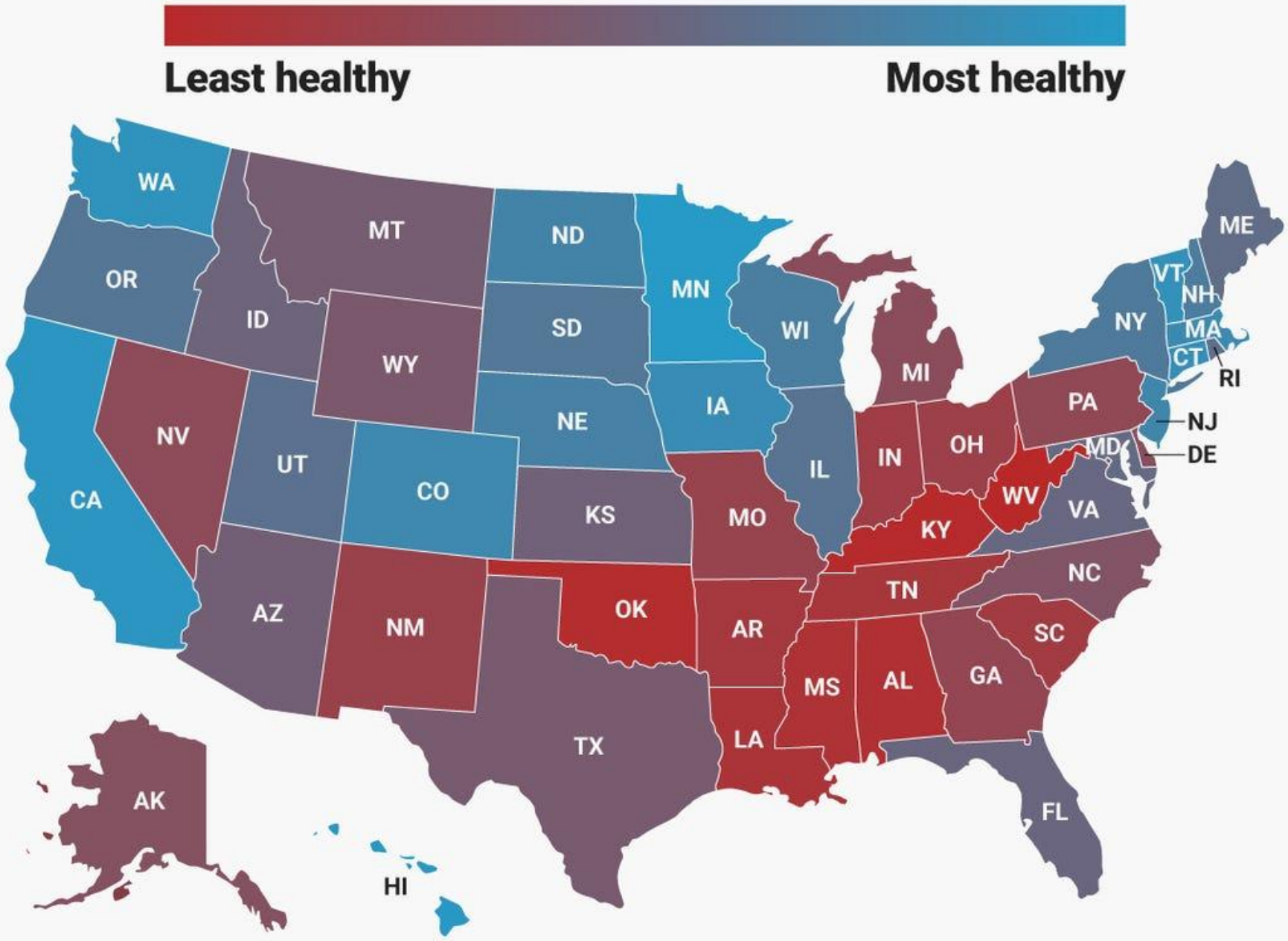
Why do you think demographers sometimes use period life expectancy, despite its flaws, instead of cohort life expectancy??

https://tinyurl.com/feb19soc170

Measuring “Healthy” Life Expectancy

- Expected years of life ***lived in good health***
- Often based on measures of functional limitation that are sufficient to impair daily activities:
  - E.g. standing, getting dressed, preparing food

- **Morbidity** = prevalence of disease in a population
  - Could be measured as: physical dysregulation, disease onset, functional limitations



Disability-Adjusted Life Expectancy Rankings by State